

Up & Down — Operator Guide

For 50pick staff who run the Up & Down game. No technical knowledge needed. Every picture is the real production screen, photographed on **4 August 2026**. 🛑 This replaces every earlier version — the rules below are new and the old guide contradicts them.

THE RULES WE SET TODAY — read this page before you touch anything

- 1 Gold only trades on certain days.** Gold (and any currency pair) is **shut every weekend**: it opens **Monday 01:00 EAT** and closes **Saturday 00:00 EAT**. The platform refuses to open or settle a gold round while the market is shut — you will see *“market shut”* on the chain, and that is correct, not a fault.
Crypto (BTC, ETH, SOL) trades 24 hours, 7 days, including weekends and public holidays.
- 2 Gold cannot run shorter than 15 minutes.** The dropdown greys 3, 5 and 10 minutes for gold and tells you why. Gold’s own price feed disagrees with itself by up to **\$0.87** at a single instant, which is more than gold typically moves in five minutes — a short gold round would be decided by which reading arrived, not by the market.
Crypto can run every length: 3, 5, 10, 15, 30, 60 minutes.
- 3 Betting stops before the round ends.** The last **20%** of every round takes no bets (never less than 30 seconds). A 5-minute round shuts betting with **60 seconds** left.
Why: near the close the result is almost already known. Without this, someone watching the price could bet on an outcome they can see coming, and take money off the players who bet honestly at the start. The player’s card says so plainly, and the countdown changes from *“betting closes in”* to *“result in”*.
- 4 The winning band is the smallest possible step — not a percentage.** The recommended setting is **“Smallest possible”**, which uses the asset’s own minimum move: **\$0.02** on Bitcoin, **\$0.40** on gold. About **99 rounds in 100** then pay a winner.
Why: we measured it. At 0.50% (the old default) BTC had to move $\pm \$316$ inside five minutes — it refunded 5 real rounds out of 5. A wide band does not make more money; it makes **no** money, because a refunded round earns no fee.
- 5 One account may only take one side of a round.** A player cannot bet UP and DOWN on the same round.
Why: betting both sides is not a bet — it is a way to move money around while paying only the fee, and on a lopsided pool it can even be profitable regardless of the result.
- 6 A round that closes late still settles — it no longer refunds.** Prices are now read from a **dated one-minute bar**, so the price at 13:52 is still the price at 13:52 an hour later. If a close is delayed we go back and read the right minute, up to **24 hours**.
Before today a late close refunded everyone even though nothing had failed.
- 7 Every refund tells the player its real reason.** Six different reasons, each in English, Swahili and Chinese, on the card, the round page, the settlement proof, the push and the inbox.
Never say *“the price did not move”* about a refund that happened for another reason — that sentence used to appear on a refund caused by nobody taking the other side.
- 8 Rounds are produced by hand.** You press **Generate round**. Nothing runs automatically.
Why: while we are learning the product, an operator watching is worth more than a timer nobody is watching. Do not start a chain and walk away.

9 If only one side bets, everybody is refunded. A round needs UP *and* DOWN money to have a winner. A one-sided round refunds every stake and earns nothing.

This is the one thing that will disappoint players in a quiet hour. Prefer few chains with players on them over many empty ones.

DO NOT **Do not run gold below 15 minutes. Do not widen the band to “look serious”. Do not add a chain nobody is playing.** Those three are the only ways an operator can lose money on this game today, and all three feel harmless.

1 · What the game is

A player bets whether a price — Bitcoin, Ethereum, gold — will be **higher (UP)** or **lower (DOWN)** at the end of a short window. One window is a **round**.

1. Round opens We read the price from the last finished minute and freeze it. That is the opening price .	2. Players bet UP or DOWN, until betting shuts in the last 20%.	3. Round closes We read the price for the closing minute — the exact same way.	4. We pay UP wins, DOWN wins, or nobody wins and everyone gets their stake back.
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THE ONE IDEA TO UNDERSTAND We settle against a dated one-minute bar, not “the price now”. Every minute of the day has a permanent record: its opening price. “The price at 13:52” means “the opening price of the bar labelled 13:52”. That number never changes, so we can always go back and check it — which is why a delayed round can still be settled honestly instead of refunded, and why nobody can argue about which price we used.

2 · How Twelve Data works in our favour

Twelve Data is the company that sells us prices. Three things about it are genuinely to our advantage, and they are the reason the game is built the way it is.

WHAT IT GIVES US	WHY THAT IS IN OUR FAVOUR
The past is readable a dated bar, not a live tick	A live price can only answer “ <i>what is it now</i> ”. Miss the instant and the number is gone forever — so a delay had to refund. A dated bar is the same number six hours later , so a late close settles correctly. It also means a player who disputes a result can be shown the exact minute we used.
A whole window costs one credit 1–5000 minutes, same price	One request can fetch a thousand minutes for the price of one. Six round lengths on one asset need about 672 separate price readings a day against a plan of roughly 800 — which would be impossible one at a time. Fetching a window instead collapses that to 24–96. This is what makes 3-minute rounds affordable at all.
Real-time crypto, forex and US shares	Our plan gives live prices for crypto, currencies and metals. That covers every asset we want. 🛑 It does not cover stock indices (the S&P 500 returns nothing), and shares outside the USA are end-of-day only — a once-a-day price cannot settle a 5-minute round, so no non-US share may ever be an Up & Down asset.

MEASURED, NOT ASSUMED A minute’s bar is published a few seconds **after** that minute ends — about **10 seconds** for BTC, ETH and gold, and about **60 seconds** for Solana. That is why **Generate round** takes the opening price from the *last finished* minute, and why the platform waits up to two minutes for a bar before it treats it as missing. You do not have to do anything about this; it is why generation sometimes takes a few seconds to answer.

3 · What is unique about each asset

These are not preferences. Each number was measured against real provider data, and it is why each asset is configured differently.

ASSET	BAND	LENGTHS	TRADING HOURS	WHAT IS UNIQUE ABOUT IT — AND WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
BTC Bitcoin READY	±\$0.02 2 ticks	3 · 5 · 10 15 · 30 · 60	24 / 7 every day	Moves whole dollars in three minutes, so almost every round has a clear winner. The two price readers agreed 75 times out of 75 when we tested them, so its band only has to clear rounding. Start here. Best asset for a 3-minute round.
ETH Ethereum READY	±\$0.02 2 ticks	3 · 5 · 10 15 · 30 · 60	24 / 7 every day	Behaves like Bitcoin but at a lower price, so the same \$0.02 band is a slightly larger share of the price — marginally more likely to refund on a very quiet 3-minute window. Safe at 5 minutes and above.
XAU Gold CARE	±\$0.40 40 ticks	15 · 30 · 60 only	Mon 01:00 EAT → Sat 00:00 EAT	The one asset that needs real care. Its own feed disagrees with itself by up to \$0.20 at a single instant and \$0.29–\$0.87 across a minute boundary — so its band is twenty times BTC's. It is also the only asset that shuts , and on a Saturday the provider still publishes flat filler prices with a \$0.02 range, which is why we refuse weekend gold outright rather than trusting the feed.
SOL Solana NOT YET	±\$0.02 2 ticks	—	24 / 7	Do not run SOL for players yet. 290 rounds ran on it historically and not one ever paid a winner . Its bars arrive about 60 seconds late rather than 10, which the new reader should now handle — but that has not been proved with money on it. It must be tested by staff first.
BNB OFF	±\$0.02 —	—	24 / 7	Switched off. Priced as a “macro” asset by mistake once, which applied gold’s weekend shutdown to a coin that trades every day. Leave it off.
SNP500 S&P 500 CANNOT WORK	±\$0.15 —	—	—	Never enable this. Stock indices are not on our price plan at all, and its stored source is a web page rather than the price feed. Every round would refund. It is kept only so nobody re-creates it.
GOLD (duplicate) OFF	±\$0.40 —	15 · 30 · 60	Mon–Sat	A second gold row , switched off. Two rows in the list both say “Gold”. Use XAU , the one that is enabled. Do not switch this one on as well, or your reports will split gold across two names.

HOW MUCH IS “A CHANGE”? Any movement of one band or more decides the round. On Bitcoin that is **2 cents** — a normal 3-minute Bitcoin move is **hundreds of times** that, which is why ~99% of rounds pay. On gold it is **40 cents**, because gold’s own feed is uncertain by up to 20 cents and we must clear that twice over. A smaller band on gold would hand rounds to whichever reading arrived first.

4 · The formulas — exactly how a round resolves, and why

Nothing here is approximate. These are the actual calculations, and every number in the worked examples is from a **real production round settled on 4 August 2026**.

4.1 · The two targets, frozen when the round opens

```
tick    = 0.01                                (the asset's smallest price step, 2 decimals)
band    = the LARGER of:  open x margin%        ... the percentage, if you set one
                                minMoveTicks x tick ... the asset's minimum move

UP target = opening price + band
DOWN target = opening price - band
```

With the recommended **Smallest possible** setting the percentage is 0, so the band is *always* the asset's minimum move. Both targets are **written onto the round at open** and never recalculated — so changing a setting later cannot alter a round players already bet on.

```
Worked example — the real round udr_a1adea90... , BTC 5m
opening price  63,856.00
band           2 ticks x 0.01 = 0.02
UP target      63,856.02      DOWN target  63,855.98
```

4.2 · The outcome

```
closing price >= UP target    -> UP wins
closing price <= DOWN target  -> DOWN wins
anything in between          -> VOID: every stake refunded in full, no fee taken
```

```
Same round
closing price  63,832.00  which is <= 63,855.98  -> DOWN WINS
```

4.3 · The money

Up & Down is a **pool** game. Everyone's stake goes into one pot; the winning side shares the pot in proportion to what each of them staked. We take a commission of **13%**, but never more than **one third of the smaller side**.

```
pool      = UP money + DOWN money
smaller    = whichever side has less money on it
commission = 13% x pool
ceiling    = 33.33% x smaller
fee        = the SMALLER of commission and ceiling
net pool   = pool - fee

one winner's payout = round( their stake / winning side's total x net pool )
```

WHY THE CEILING EXISTS It guarantees a winner can never receive less than they staked. Because the fee can never exceed a third of the smaller side, the net pool is always at least as large as the winning side — so every winner gets back *at least* their stake. The platform **refuses to settle** a round where that is not true, rather than pay a “winner” less than they put in. You will never have to explain that to a player, because it cannot happen.

Worked example A – a balanced round (the real one)

UP 500 + DOWN 500 pool 1,000 smaller 500
commission $13\% \times 1,000 = 130$
ceiling $33.33\% \times 500 = 166.67$
fee $\min(130, 166.67) = 130$ net pool 870
DOWN won. One winner staked 500 of the 500 on DOWN:
payout = $500/500 \times 870 = 870$ the platform keeps 130

Worked example B – a lopsided round, showing the ceiling bite

UP 900 + DOWN 100 pool 1,000 smaller 100
commission $13\% \times 1,000 = 130$
ceiling $33.33\% \times 100 = 33.33$
fee $\min(130, 33.33) = 33.33$ CAPPED net pool 966.67
If DOWN wins, its single 100 backer receives 966 - nearly ten times the stake.
If UP wins, the 900 receives 966. Either way, above the stake.

4.4 · When betting shuts

lead = the LARGER of (20% of the round , 30 seconds)
betting shuts at = closing time - lead

ROUND LENGTH	3 MIN	5 MIN	10 MIN	15 MIN	30 MIN	60 MIN
Betting shuts with ... left	36s	60s	2m	3m	6m	12m

At that moment the player's buttons grey out, the card explains why, and the estimate "× 1.4 est." is replaced by an **exact figure** — because once the pool is frozen we know precisely what each side would receive.

4.5 · Which round lengths are allowed, and why only those six

a length is allowed only if it divides evenly into 1440 (the minutes in a day)
 $3 \cdot 5 \cdot 10 \cdot 15 \cdot 30 \cdot 60$ -> allowed
 $4 \cdot 7 \cdot 45$ -> refused

A length that divides the day makes every round start on a clean clock mark, the same marks every day. It also means several lengths share boundaries, so one price reading serves many rounds — the credit saving described in section 2.

4.6 · If a price cannot be read

a "not published yet" answer within 120 seconds -> free, we simply retry
retries at 15s, 45s, then 120s, up to 4 real attempts
still nothing after 390 seconds -> VOID, everyone refunded
a delayed close, up to 24 hours later -> we read the correct minute and SETTLE

You do not manage any of this. It is here so that when you see "confirming price" for a minute or two, you know it is the system retrying on purpose and not something you should touch.

5 · Finding it, and who is allowed to do what

MARKETS · MASOKO

Event calendar

AI poll generation

AI candidates

Player proposals

Curation queue

Resolver queue

Sources & categories

UP & DOWN · JUU NA CHINI

Overview

AI proposals

Rounds

Up & Down is a **separate game** from the normal polls, with its own section near the bottom of the sidebar: **UP & DOWN · JUU NA CHINI**. It has three screens — **Overview** (what you trade and the chains that produce rounds), **AI proposals**, and **Rounds** (every round that has run).

⚠ You will **not** find Up & Down rounds under *Markets* → *Curation queue*. That section is long-form polls only.

YOUR ROLE	YOU CAN
Trading officer	Add, edit, start, stop and Generate chains. Void a stuck round.
Accounting / Owner	Everything above, plus add and edit assets and change the product settings.

If a button reads  **ACCOUNTING ONLY**, that is by design. Assets decide where real money’s price comes from, so they are deliberately not a trading-desk control. Ask the owner — do not look for a way around it.

6 · The Overview screen

INTERNAL ONLY

50PICK AFRICA · TRADING · SESSION #007E · QA TRADING OFFICER (TEST)

Admin / Up & Down

< BACK TO APP

🔄

📊 AI 3/4

TRADING

QA

Up & Down

Juu na Chini

ADD ASSET · ACCOUNTING ONLY

ENABLED ASSETS

4

Bidhaa hai

▲ 7 total

RUNNING CHAINS

0

Minyororo hai

▲ 0 configured

FEE · BALANCED 10,000

TZS 1,300

Ada

▲ capped-commission 13%

STALENESS WINDOW

90s

Muda wa bei

▲ confidence ≥ 85

Up & Down economics · this game only

Uchumi wa mchezo huu

LAST 30 DAYS · UPDOWN ONLY

TODAY

YESTERDAY

LAST 24H

7 DAYS

30 DAYS

MONTH

ALL TIME

CUSTOM

GGR · THIS GAME

TZS 0

Mapato

▲ hold 0.0%

STAKED

TZS 0

Zilizowekwa

▲ 0 bets

PAID OUT

TZS 0

Zilizolipwa

▲ 0 players

AI ORACLE COST

\$62.73

Gharama ya AI

▲ 673 calls · 98d \$62.73

This is Up & Down alone— long-form polls are reported separately under Money → Reports. GGR is the commission kept on this game (TZS); AI cost is what its price oracle spent (USD). The platform’s combined figures, and the TRA/GBT levy on total commission, are unchanged.

Assets · 7

Bidhaa

Top row: how many assets are on, how many chains are running, the fee on a balanced TZS 10,000 pool, and the **staleness window** (how fresh a price must be — 90 seconds). **Middle:** the money for this game only, over the period you choose. **Bottom:** your assets and your chains. This is the real screen on the day the board was cleared for training — **0 chains**, which is exactly what you should see before you create the first one.

KEY	NAME	SOURCE	PRECISION	CHAINS	ENABLED	
BNB	BNB BNB/USD · BNB	api.twelvedata.com macro	2 dp · min 2	0/0	⚙ EDIT ASSET · ACCOUNTING ONLY	⚙ DISABLED · ACCOUNTING ONLY
BTC	Bitcoin BTC/USD · Bitcoin	api.twelvedata.com crypto	2 dp · min 2	0/0	⚙ EDIT ASSET · ACCOUNTING ONLY	⚙ ENABLED · ACCOUNTING ONLY
ETH	Ethereum ETH/USD · Ethereum	api.twelvedata.com crypto	2 dp · min 2	0/0	⚙ EDIT ASSET · ACCOUNTING ONLY	⚙ ENABLED · ACCOUNTING ONLY
GOLD	Gold XAU/USD · Dhahabu	api.twelvedata.com macro	2 dp · min 40	0/0	⚙ EDIT ASSET · ACCOUNTING ONLY	⚙ DISABLED · ACCOUNTING ONLY
SNP500	S&P 500 S&P500 · S&P 500	kitco.com macro	2 dp · min 15	0/0	⚙ EDIT ASSET · ACCOUNTING ONLY	⚙ DISABLED · ACCOUNTING ONLY
SOL	Solana SOL/USD · Solana	api.twelvedata.com crypto	2 dp · min 2	0/0	⚙ EDIT ASSET · ACCOUNTING ONLY	⚙ ENABLED · ACCOUNTING ONLY
XAU	Gold XAU/USD · Dhahabu	api.twelvedata.com macro	2 dp · min 40	0/0	⚙ EDIT ASSET · ACCOUNTING ONLY	⚙ ENABLED · ACCOUNTING ONLY

Every asset, with **PRECISION** showing the band: 2 dp · min 40 means prices carry 2 decimals and gold's minimum move is 40 of them — **±\$0.40**. Note **two rows called “Gold”**: use **XAU**, the enabled one. Every control here reads **ACCOUNTING ONLY** for a trading officer, which is correct.

7 · Every field, with an example of what to put in it

7.1 · Add chain — the form you will use most

ADD CHAIN

ASSET

DURATION

WINNING BAND

MIN STAKE (OPTIONAL)

MAX STAKE (OPTIONAL)

① BTC · Bitco... ▾

① 5 min ▾

Smallest possi... ▾

inherit

inherit

The winning band is ± this much from the opening price, frozen onto each round at open. This chain inherits the smallest possible step if you leave it on the recommended choice. Anything between the two targets refunds every stake.

Add chain

Cancel

The real form. ① beside an option means ready; ② means usable with a warning; ③ means unusable and is greyed out *with the reason shown* — never hidden, so you can always see why gold has no 5-minute option.

FIELD	PUT THIS	WHAT IT MEANS, AND WHAT HAPPENS IF YOU GET IT WRONG
Asset	① BTC · Bitcoin	Which price the round follows. A dropdown, never typed. ③ options cannot be chosen at all. <i>Start with BTC.</i>
Duration	① 5 min	How long a round lasts. Only the six allowed lengths appear. Changing the asset re-checks this list — pick gold and the short options grey out immediately, with the reason. <i>5 minutes is the best length to learn on: long enough to place bets, short enough to see a result while you are watching.</i>
Winning band	Smallest possible (recommended)	How far the price must move for a side to win. Leave it on the recommendation. The other options exist for a long round on a slow asset: · Smallest possible — the asset's minimum move. ~99 in 100 rounds pay. · Narrow · 0.02% — about 1 round in 3 refunds. · Wide · 0.05% — most rounds refund. · Very wide · 0.50% — almost every short round refunds and earns nothing.
Min stake	leave blank	Blank inherits the product setting, currently TZS 500 . Only set it to raise the floor on one chain.
Max stake	leave blank	Blank inherits TZS 1,000,000 . Lower it on a new chain if you want to limit exposure while it is unproven.

WHAT ABOUT 0.15%? There is no 0.15% option, and that is deliberate. On Bitcoin at \$63,856, a 0.15% band is **± \$95.78** — Bitcoin must travel almost a hundred dollars inside the round for anyone to win. In five minutes it usually does not, so nearly every round would refund and earn **nothing**. The dropdown offers only values that mean something: the minimum move, 0.02%, 0.05%, and 0.50% kept as a clearly-labelled warning of what too wide looks like. **A wider band does not make a bigger margin — it makes no margin at all.**

7.2 · The chain row, and the Generate button

CHAIN	STATE	NEXT BOUNDARY	MARKET	MARGIN	PAID A WINNER · 7D	STAKE BOUNDS	CONTROLS
BTC 5m Bitcoin	STOPPED	—	open	0.00%	—	inherit	Edit Generate round Start

STATE stopped or running · **NEXT BOUNDARY** when the next round would open · **MARKET** whether the asset is trading right now (gold reads *shut* at the weekend) · **MARGIN** the winning band — **±0.02 · min move** is the recommended setting, and it means 2 cents, **not** “no band” · **PAID A WINNER · 7D** the honest health figure: what share of the last week's rounds actually paid somebody. — means no rounds yet.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES · WHEN TO USE IT
Generate round	Creates one round, right now, and opens it for betting. This is your main button. It reads the opening price from the last finished minute; if it cannot read a price it refuses and creates nothing — no round, no stakes, nothing to unwind.
Start / Stop	Arms the chain to produce rounds on the clock. Leave chains stopped for now and use Generate. Stop lets open rounds finish normally — no player is left holding a bet.
Edit	Changes the band and the stake bounds. Future rounds only ; rounds already open keep what they froze at open.

EDIT BTC 5M

WINNING BAND	MIN STAKE (BLANK = INHERIT)	MAX STAKE (BLANK = INHERIT)
Sma... ▾	inherit	inherit

The band is the winning distance: **UP at open + band**, **DOWN at open – band**, and a close anywhere between the two refunds every stake and earns no fee. A band wider than the asset actually moves in one round refunds nearly every round *even when the price feed is working perfectly* — measured on production, 0.50% needs a ±\$316 move on BTC inside five minutes and refunded 5 rounds out of 5. **The smallest possible step is the recommendation:** it is the asset's own minimum move, which is 2 ticks on BTC and 40 on gold — never one, so no round can be decided by rounding. Changes affect FUTURE rounds only; rounds already open keep what they froze at open.

Save chain

Cancel

The Edit panel (it opens inside the chain's own row, so it is narrow and the fields stack). The band is the **same dropdown** as the Add form — you cannot type a number here either, and for the same reason.

Inherit follows the product setting, so changing that one setting changes every chain that inherits it. The other three choices override this chain alone.

⚠ Changes affect future rounds only. A round already open keeps the band it froze at open — otherwise the rule a player bet under could be changed after they had bet.

7.3 · Product settings — Owner / Accounting only

You will rarely change these. They are documented so that if you are asked to read one out, you know what it is. **The live value is shown in bold.**

SETTING	LIVE VALUE	WHAT IT DOES — AND THE CONSEQUENCE OF CHANGING IT
Reading method	Feed	How a price is obtained. Feed is the price provider. <i>Simulated</i> invents prices and must never touch real money — it makes you type SIMULATED to confirm, and that prompt is your signal to stop.
Feed provider	Twelve Data — dated bars	 The most consequential control on the page. “Dated bars” is what makes a late close settle instead of refund. The older “live quote” option is kept only as an emergency fallback. Do not change it without the owner.
Fallback margin	0.00%	What a chain inherits when its band is left on Inherit. 0.00% means the asset’s minimum move — not “no band”. Raising it widens the band on <i>every</i> inheriting chain at once.
Staleness	90 s	How old a price may be and still be accepted. Lower is stricter; too low and honest readings get refused and rounds refund.
Confidence floor	85	How sure a reading must be before we settle money on it. Leave it.
Max attempts	4	How many real attempts to read a price before the round refunds. A “not published yet” answer inside 120 seconds does not count against this.
Default min / max stake	500 / 1,000,000	The bounds every chain inherits, in TZS.

7.4 · Add asset — Owner / Accounting only

FIELD	EXAMPLE	WHAT IT MEANS
Asset class	crypto	🛑 Decides the trading calendar. crypto = 24/7; anything else follows the gold/currency week and shuts at weekends. Getting this wrong once shut a coin that trades every day. It is locked to the symbol for exactly that reason.
Symbol	① BTC/USD	A dropdown of only the symbols our price plan actually carries. Typing a symbol the feed does not have produced 27 refunded rounds out of 27 once — hence the list.
Key	BTC	Your short name. Never renamed — every report groups by it.
Name EN / SW	Bitcoin / Bitcoin	What players see, in English and Swahili.
Decimals	2	How many decimal places the price carries. Sets the size of one tick.
Min move (ticks)	2 · gold 40	The band, in ticks. The form will not accept 1: a one-tick band is the same size as the rounding error on the price, so the round would be decided by rounding rather than by the market. The number to use is measured per asset — see section 3.
Price source URL	https://api.twelvedata.com/quote	The approved provider address. Must be https:// and its host must already be approved under <i>Sources & categories</i> . The exact path does not matter — the reader supplies its own.

8 · Your first live round — the ten-minute walkthrough

1. **Up & Down** → **Overview**. Confirm BTC is enabled and reads 2 dp · min 2 .
2. + **Add chain** → Asset ① BTC · Bitcoin → Duration ① 5 min → Winning band Smallest possible → stakes blank → **Add chain**. It appears **STOPPED**. That is correct.
3. Check **MARKET** reads *open* and **MARGIN** reads ±0.02 · min move .
4. Press **Generate round**. Wait for the row to show a round. *If it refuses with "could not read a price", wait fifteen seconds and press it again* — you were inside the few seconds before the minute's bar was published.
5. Open **50pick.tz/updown** in another tab as a player. Your round is on the **5 min** tab — the board opens on 3 min by default, so a 5-minute round is *not* missing, you are on the wrong tab.
6. Place a small bet on **UP**. Watch **VOL** grow. From a second account bet **DOWN** — you need both sides or the round refunds.
7. With 60 seconds left, watch the buttons grey out, the wording change from "*betting closes in*" to "*result in*", and the estimate become an exact figure.
8. At the close the card shows the result. Check **Rounds**: the outcome, the stake, the players and the settlement time.
9. Check the winner's wallet went up by the amount the card promised. **It will agree to the shilling.**

THIS EXACT WALKTHROUGH WAS DONE ON PRODUCTION BTC 5-minute round, real money on both sides, opening 63,856.00 → closing 63,832.00 → **DOWN**. The UP stake of 500 paid 0; the DOWN stake of 500 paid **870**; the winner's wallet went from 24,400 to **25,270**. Pool 1,000, fee 130. Every figure matched.

9 · Refunds — the six reasons, and what to tell a player

A refund is **not** a loss and **not** an error. The player gets their whole stake back and we take no fee. But a player who is refunded always wants to know why, and the reason is on their screen already — in English, Swahili or Chinese, whichever they use. **Read it before answering.**

REASON SHOWN	WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED	WHAT YOU SAY
Price did not move enough no-move	The close landed between the two targets. Rare on the recommended band.	"The price finished inside the band, so neither side won. Your full stake is back."
Nobody took the other side unmatched	Only UP or only DOWN had money. There was no pool to pay from.	"Nobody bet against you, so there was nothing to win and nothing to lose. Your stake is back in full."  Never call this "the price did not move" — it used to say that, and it was wrong.
We could not read the price source-failed	The provider did not answer in time. Our problem, not theirs.	"We could not confirm the closing price, so we refunded everyone rather than guess."
Market was shut market-closed	A gold round hit the weekend.	"Gold does not trade at weekends, so the round could not be settled and everyone was refunded."
Cancelled by us operator	Staff voided it deliberately. The reason you typed is on the record permanently.	Whatever the truth is. Always give a real reason when you void.
Round expired abandoned	No price could be read within the deadline at all.	"We ran out of time to confirm a price, so every stake was returned."

NEVER

Never announce a price we have not confirmed. If a screen shows a dash, that *is* the honest answer. Do not fill it in from another website — the round did not settle on that website and the player was never told it would.

10 · Your daily check — five minutes

1. **Rounds** — are recent rounds resolving UP/DOWN rather than a run of refunds?
2. **PAID A WINNER · 7D** on each chain. On the recommended band this should be high. A low figure with reason `source-failed` is **our** problem — tell the technical team. A low figure with `no-move` means the band is too wide for that asset and length.
3. **MARKET** column — gold reads *shut* at the weekend. Expected, not a fault.
4. **Both sides betting?** A chain whose rounds keep refunding as `unmatched` has no audience. Stop it and put the players on one busier chain instead.
5. **Money** — staked and paid out look sensible for the day.

11 · When something looks wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
Generate says “ could not read a price ”	You pressed it in the few seconds before the minute’s bar was published. Nothing was created.	Wait fifteen seconds and press it again. If it fails three times, tell the technical team.
Gold chain reads market shut	It is between Saturday 00:00 and Monday 01:00 EAT.	Nothing. Correct behaviour. Run crypto over the weekend.
Rounds keep refunding unmatched	Only one side is betting.	Fewer chains, more players per chain. This is a liquidity problem, not a fault.
Rounds keep refunding no-move	The band is too wide for that asset over that length.	Edit the chain → band → Smallest possible . Future rounds only.
“ Confirming price ” for a minute or two	The retry ladder, working as designed.	Wait. If it never confirms, the round refunds by itself.
A round is stuck holding money	Something went wrong for that one round.	Rounds → Void , with a real reason. Every stake is refunded in full.
You cannot change an asset’s price source	A round that captured the old source is still unresolved.	Correct behaviour — those players were told the old source. Let them finish first.
A button reads  ACCOUNTING ONLY	Your role cannot use that control.	Ask the owner. Do not look for a way around it.

12 · Words you will see

WORD	MEANING
Asset	A thing with a price — Bitcoin, Ethereum, gold.
Chain	One asset at one length. “BTC 5m” is one chain. It is what produces rounds.
Round	One window players bet on.
Band / margin	How far the price must move for a side to win. ±0.02 on BTC.
Tick	The smallest step a price can take. At 2 decimals, one tick is 0.01.
Boundary	The clock mark where one round ends and the next begins.
Bar	One minute’s permanent price record. What we settle against.
VOID	No winner. Every stake refunded in full, no fee taken.
Pool	All the money staked on a round.
GGR	What the platform keeps: staked minus paid out.
Staleness window	How old a price may be and still be accepted. 90 seconds.

IF IN DOUBT **Stop the chain.** Stopping prevents new rounds and lets open ones finish normally — no player is left holding a bet. It is always safe, it never needs technical help, and it is undone in one click.

50pick · Up & Down Operator Guide · Internal use only · Written 4 August 2026, against the live production configuration of that date. Every figure was read off production, not estimated. Technical detail lives in `docs/UPDOWN-SPEC.md` — you do not need it to run the game.